Put What Dad Owns on One Page So Your Questions Are Ready Before You Need Them

Four prompts to build a dated inventory, note how each thing is owned, write down the changes your family is thinking about, and agree on what would prompt a conversation with a professional.

Where you are

Dad is managing fine and nothing has happened. You've started to wonder what long-term care would mean for the house and the savings, and you realize nobody in the family has a complete list of what he owns or whose name is on it.

This guide gives you four ChatGPT prompts to organize what you already know and to see what you don't know yet. It is preparation, not an assessment. Use only information you have permission to share, with names and account numbers removed. The AI organizes and drafts; it does not give legal, financial, or Medicaid eligibility advice, and the rules vary by state. Bring those questions to the right professional.

What you'll have at the end

You have a dated inventory of what Dad owns and how it's owned, a short list of changes the family is considering, and the questions to bring to a professional before acting on any of them.

A one-page baseline: What Dad owns and how it's owned, What we don't know yet, Changes we're thinking about, and Questions to ask before we act, with who to ask.

Before you start

- A rough list of what Dad owns: the home, savings, investments, retirement accounts, insurance, and anything else of value.
- Whatever you know about whose name is on each one and who the beneficiaries are.
- Any changes the family has talked about, such as adding a name to an account or changing a deed. Two of the three is plenty.

PROMPT 1

Build a dated inventory

WHY THIS MATTERS

A home, savings, retirement accounts, and insurance may not all be treated the same way under Medicaid rules. Before anyone can say how, there has to be a list.

WHAT YOU'LL NEED

Your rough list of what Dad owns. Round numbers and guesses are fine if you mark them as guesses.

COPY THIS PROMPT

> I'm planning ahead for my father. Nothing is urgent. Here is what I know about what he owns:

> [PASTE YOUR LIST]
>
> Turn this into a dated inventory with these headings: HOME AND OTHER REAL ESTATE, CASH AND SAVINGS, INVESTMENTS, RETIREMENT ACCOUNTS, INSURANCE AND ANNUITIES, PERSONAL PROPERTY, BUSINESS INTERESTS. Under each heading, list only what I described. Where I said nothing, write “not noted” so I can see the blank. Do not estimate values I didn’t give, and do not comment on how Medicaid would treat anything.

WHAT TO LOOK FOR

A list with blanks you can see, not a verdict.

WHAT TO DO NEXT

Put today’s date at the top and fill in what a statement or a conversation with Dad can settle.

PROMPT 2

Note how each thing is owned

WHY THIS MATTERS

Whose name is on an asset and who its beneficiary is come up in most professional conversations about these questions, and they’re easy to be unsure of.

WHAT YOU'LL NEED

The inventory from the first prompt, plus anything you know about names on deeds, accounts, and beneficiary forms.

COPY THIS PROMPT

> Here is my father’s inventory and what I know about ownership:
>
> [PASTE THE RESULT OF PROMPT 1 AND YOUR NOTES]
>
> Add three columns to the inventory: WHOSE NAME IS ON IT (his alone, joint with his spouse, joint with someone else, a trust, or not sure), NAMED BENEFICIARY (a name, none, or not sure), and WHEN WE LAST CHECKED. Then list every “not sure” as something to look up. Do not tell me whether any ownership arrangement is good or bad for Medicaid purposes.

WHAT TO LOOK FOR

The “not sure” entries. Looking them up doesn’t require deciding anything.

WHAT TO DO NEXT

Check deeds, statements, and beneficiary forms for the “not sure” items when it’s convenient.

PROMPT 3

Write down the changes you’re thinking about

WHY THIS MATTERS

Decisions made years before care is needed can sometimes affect the options available later. Writing a possible change down, with the question it raises, lets a professional weigh in on it first.

WHAT YOU'LL NEED

Any changes the family has discussed: a gift, adding a child to an account, changing a deed, moving money, buying a product.

COPY THIS PROMPT

> Here are changes our family has talked about making to my father’s finances or property:
>
> [PASTE YOUR NOTES]
>
> For each one, write four short lines: WHAT WE’RE CONSIDERING, WHY, WHO SUGGESTED IT, and WHAT WE’D WANT TO ASK A PROFESSIONAL FIRST. Do not tell me whether any of these is a good idea, how Medicaid would treat it, or what the consequences would be. Those depend on state rules and our facts, and I will ask an elder law attorney.

WHAT TO LOOK FOR

A question attached to each possible change, with nothing decided.

WHAT TO DO NEXT

Bring the list to your conversation with an elder law attorney.

PROMPT 4

Agree on what would prompt a conversation

WHY THIS MATTERS

Planning ahead doesn’t mean deciding everything now. It means knowing which events would be the moment to bring a professional in.

WHAT YOU'LL NEED

The results of the first three prompts.

COPY THIS PROMPT

> Here is everything I've put together about what my father owns:
>
> [PASTE THE RESULTS OF PROMPTS 1 TO 3]
>
> Write one page with four headings: WHAT DAD OWNS AND HOW IT'S OWNED, WHAT WE DON'T KNOW YET, CHANGES WE'RE THINKING ABOUT, and QUESTIONS TO ASK BEFORE WE ACT. Mark each question with who to ask: Dad, the family, a Medicaid planner, an elder law attorney, a licensed financial professional, or not sure. Then add a short list titled WHEN WE'LL LOOK AT THIS AGAIN, using only events we could observe, such as a change in health, a move, a sale of property, or a death in the family. Do not rank the events and do not estimate how likely any of them is.

WHAT TO LOOK FOR

One dated page a brother or sister could read and understand.

WHAT TO DO NEXT

Share the page with one other family member and agree when you'll look at it again.

Turn the page into a planning report

An inventory is a good start, and it only holds what you thought to write down. The planning interview goes through your family's situation step by step, including the parts you left out, and gives you a free planning report to review with a professional.

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